

be shared over IM unless you are more than 100 per cent sure of the trustworthiness of the receiver.

- Avoid using your real name as far as possible.
- Blocking is a very effective tool to keep away individuals who have appeared on your contact list uninvited. Use it, use it often.
- If you get a lot of chat spam (inviting you to view Webcams, and so forth) on your instant messenger, you can change your Privacy settings to allow only those on your contacts list to send you messages.
- When chatting at a cybercafé or at a location away from your home, make sure your chat logs are not being saved. You can check this in the Options menu of most IM clients.

8.4.2 Prevent Webcam Hacking

If you are used to chatting over IM with a Webcam, then you're probably aware of the fact that your Webcam can be accessed by anyone on the IM network who knows your IM username. The important thing is to stop malicious people from hacking into your Webcam. The easiest thing to do in such a situation is to disconnect your Webcam when you don't intend to video-chat. However, if you must leave it on, in the Options/Preferences menu of your IM client, change the settings so that people can only view your Webcam with your permission.

8.5 Using P2P Wisely

Peer-to-peer networks are considered by some to be the best thing to have happened to computers since the Internet. Everyone knows what they do and what they're capable of. Yet, P2P networks are also one of the biggest security threats to your computer. There are tons of files infected with viruses and distributed over these networks. However, there are a few rules you can follow to make sure you have an enjoyable and safe P2P experience: